



# CUSTOMISE YOUR PHONE

Your phone makes a statement about who you are. Use this section to learn how to root your Android phone, back it up, make a custom ROM and even accessorise it

The following rooting guide is divided into three sections: backing up, rooting, and then installing the ROM of your choice – which could include building your own ROM. After all, that is the point of rooting in the first place – to customise your phone to your specific needs.

## BACKUP!

Before you dive into the world of rooted Android you have to backup everything, just in case. It's the smart move, even though nothing will probably go wrong if you follow this rooting guide to the letter.

## FRIENDLY ANDROID

Android has a good inbuilt mechanism to assist you in backing up anything vital on your smartphone. Using cloud services is probably the best way to backup everything, and most of us are probably already doing so. You can also always copy your pictures, music, etc., to your PC, but let Google handle all your contacts and SMSes. That way you just need to sign in with your account and import everything back automatically.

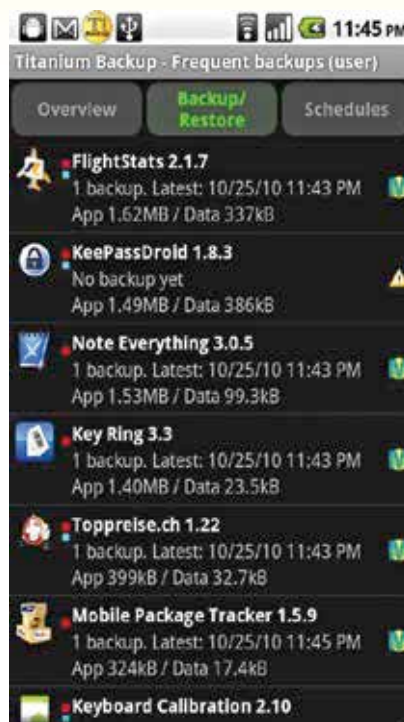
## AFTER ROOTING

It's backing up your rooted phone that really matters, really, and even though we haven't even got there yet, we're just lumping all the backing up guides together. The thing with custom ROMs is that they're addictive, and fiddling with them often results in crashed OSes that need to be reinstalled. No one said being a geek was easy! This is why you need more powerful backup tools:

- **Titanium Backup**

This app lets you backup apps, data and market links. By backing up apps, we do mean all your installed apps along with the system apps on your phone and their data. The app also lets you schedule backups and do one-click

batch backups. The paid Pro version unlocks a few more handy features such as integrating app updates to ROM, encryption, restoring individual apps+data from non-root ADB, CWM and TWRP backups and more.



Use Titanium backup once you've rooted

- **Helium Backup**

Helium backup is an app that will let you backup apps and their data even before rooting. You will need the Helium desktop client installed. With USB debugging enabled on your phone, start the Helium Desktop app as well as the Helium app on your phone. Then connect your phone to the PC and wait for it to be detected. Once it does get detected, you can unplug the phone. Going to the Helium app will now show you the option of backing up your apps to a location of your preference – internal memory, SD card or the cloud. This backup can be restored by the 'Restore and Sync' functionality.

## CUSTOM RECOVERY

Creating a manual backup for your phone is a good idea as well, if you're sure about the recovery process. A custom recovery is essentially a third party recovery environment which



The TWRP recovery interface

replaces your stock recovery environment when flashed onto your device. These third party alternatives offer a lot of features like rooting as well custom backups. The two popular options for custom recovery are Clockworkmod Recovery (CWM) and Team Win Recovery Project (TWRP)

- **Clockworkmod Recovery (CWM):** This recovery can create and restore NANDroid backups – backups of an Android device's entire file system. It also has other advanced features that will be useful if you are install and deal with custom ROMs.
- **Team Win Recovery Project (TWRP):** This is a touch-based